



Asus ZenFone 7

The device was spotted on Geekbench, has a flip camera and could be powered by the Snapdragon 865. <https://dgit.in/jul20-105>



Asus ROG Phone III

A leaked video shows what is allegedly the Asus ROG Phone III with an overclocked Snapdragon 865. <https://dgit.in/jul20-106>

Mi Notebook 14 Horizon

Shaking up the mainstream

If there's something Xiaomi is good at, it's shaking things up real hard in whatever segment it enters. They did this with its smartphones across various budget and performance ranges and now, they're finally entering the laptop space. The Mi Notebook 14 falls at the intersection of mainstream and thing-and-light laptop categories, offering key features from both segments in one laptop. After using the laptop as our primary machine for a few days, here is our Xiaomi Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition review.

Performance

Packing the latest from Intel in the form of their Comet Lake Core i7-10710U paired with 8GB DDR4 memory (soldered, non-upgradeable), a fast 512GB NVMe drive and the Nvidia GeForce MX 350, the Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition really gets the hardware very right. Do note that this is the top-end variant and costs ₹59,999.

Benchmarking the machine reveals impressive performance. We start off with PCMark 10 and its office-centric benchmark tools, followed by disk speed measurement and of course, the performance of the new Nvidia GeForce MX350. The device scored 4924 on PCMark 8 Work, 4205 on PCMark 10, 3872 on 3DMark Fire Strike and 10992 on 3DMark Sky Diver. Backing the benchmark performance is the day-to-day performance of the Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition. We used the laptop for a week as our daily driver and found that despite having close to 20 tabs open in Firefox at all times, several word files and a few of our scoring sheets open in Excel, the machine would not break a sweat. The signs of struggle only showed when we fired up Adobe Lightroom to run an edit on 50-odd RAW files. Despite the discrete graphics, the machine stuttered between every movement of the adjust-



ment slider. Switching over to Photoshop, again editing RAW files one at a time was less than fluid in ACR. With the image loaded in Photoshop, adjusting curves saw occasional stutter as did painting in masks. The Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition is great for day-to-day use, but definitely falls short as an option for creators.

Display

The Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition features a 14-inch Full HD IPS display. What makes the Mi Notebook 14 a "Horizon Edition" machine are the slim bezels. Its definitely a good-looking panel with great viewing angles and good colour reproduction. The panel is very bright, hitting the 430-lux mark. We were able to use the Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition without any strain on our eyes even outdoors. The matte coating on the display definitely works well in suppressing reflections, but don't expect it to be effective against bright, point sources of light such as the sun, or even a high-wattage bulb. The display hinge is also very well crafted.

Battery

The Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition packs a 48-waatt hour battery and manages to leave us very impressed. On the PCMark 10 battery benchmark, the machine lasted 7 hours and 10 minutes, a very impressive number by itself. We followed up the benchmark

tests by using the machine without being plugged in for a few days, and got about 6 hours of use each time. Our usage involved 30-45 minutes of watching Netflix, along with lots of writing and researching, a usual part of the job. As we mentioned before, there were 20+ tabs open in Firefox, and frequent jumps between various MS Office tools. The battery life is definitely a highly scoring aspect of the Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition.

Bottomline

The Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition is a surprisingly good laptop. Its performance is adequate, but perhaps its best feature is the sturdy build quality all around. What doesn't work is the lack of back-

lighting on the keyboard and less than satisfying typing experience, coupled with a trackpad that has too much play. Redeeming the corners cut is the impressive battery life and when you factor in the good quality of the display and the fact that this machine weighs just 1.35 kilograms, we actually have a viable option for a thin and light machine in this price bracket. The Mi Notebook 14 Horizon Edition is ideally suited for anyone who is looking for a laptop to fulfil their daily needs of entertainment, typing, researching on the web and maybe, just maybe, even very light photo editing. It is not meant for those who are looking for a budget-friendly editing or gaming machine. For those, you're still better off going with an actual budget gaming laptop like the Asus TUF Gaming A15 or the Acer Predator Triton 300.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

OS: Windows 10 Home Edition | PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7-10510U | GRAPHICS: NVIDIA GeForce MX350 | DISPLAY: 35.56cm(14) Full HD (1920 x 1080) | MEMORY: 8GB 2666MHz DDR4 RAM | STORAGE: 512GB PCI Express Gen 3 NVMe SSD, 512GB SATA 3 SSD | DIMENSIONS: Thickness - 17.15mm, length - 321.3mm, width: 206.8mm, weight: 1.35kg

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